

ArenaLink v1.0 — Operator Guide

Winsford Swim Team | Arena League Gala Recording

Before You Start

1. Launch ArenaLink using the desktop shortcut.
2. Open the Arena League spreadsheet in Excel.

Make sure Excel shows no read-only warning — close and reopen if needed.

3. Check the status bar shows **Watching:** and that the correct network drive is shown.
4. Check the top of the screen shows the correct team (A TEAMS or B TEAMS).

If the wrong team is shown, click the gear icon to open Settings.

Normal Race Flow

1. Timing file arrives automatically — app comes to front.
2. Check the Event and Race number match what was just swum.
3. Verify lane times look correct on screen.
4. Click **FILL SPREADSHEET** — times are written to Excel.
5. Check the spreadsheet row. Times are entered without colons or dots — e.g. 1:23.45 becomes 12345. This is normal and expected.
6. Click **ENTRY DONE** — unlocks the next race.

The app also auto-copies times to clipboard as a backup.

Indicators

- Green button — copied and ready to paste
- Yellow panel — backup time used, ref notified, no action needed
- Orange panel — empty lane detected, confirm before proceeding
- * after a time — backup time was used for that lane
- LANE EMPTY — no swimmer was recorded for that lane

If Files Queue Up

Files that arrive before you click Entry Done are queued automatically.

A yellow alert shows how many are waiting.

After clicking Entry Done the next file loads immediately.

Settings (gear icon)

- Watch Folder — path to timing system network share
- Team — A Teams = Heat 1, B Teams = Heat 2
- Excel Path — path to the scoring spreadsheet
- Auto-fill — enable or disable Fill Spreadsheet button
- Delete Log — reset processed file history

If ArenaLink Crashes

1. Relaunch ArenaLink using the desktop shortcut.
2. Click **Process Unprocessed Files**.
3. Work through any missed races one by one as normal.

All processed races are logged — nothing is permanently lost.

Reviewing a Previous Race

Click **Review a Previous File** at the bottom of the screen.

Select the race from the list.

Click **Fill Spreadsheet** to re-fill if needed.

Click **Exit Review Mode** when done.

Common Problems

- App shakes when I press X — a window is open. Close it first.
- Fill fails: Sheet 'Recording' not found — the tab has been renamed.

Rename it back to exactly: Recording

- Files not detected — check the network share is accessible.
- Wrong times or missing races — check correct team is set (A or B).

Emergency Manual Entry

If ArenaLink cannot fill the spreadsheet, enter times by hand.

The spreadsheet expects times in MMSSH format — no colons or dots.

To convert a time manually:

- 1:23.45 — remove colon and dot — enter as 12345
- 54.32 (under a minute) — enter as 5432
- 2:10.08 — enter as 21008

Column D = Lane 1, E = Lane 2, F = Lane 3, G = Lane 4.

Leave the cell blank if a lane was empty (DNS).